Q+A

# IF LOOKS COULD KILL

*After his dazzling appearance in* khadi *at Cannes,* ***Taha Shah Badussha****, star of* Heeramandi *(2024), is at a unique crossroads with several upcoming projects*

**Q. What inspired you to become an actor?**
I think it's about escaping oneself, and having the ability to experience different lives and different times, jumping from era to era, nationality to nationality, lingo to lingo. Overall, it's the creativity in the quest of finding who I am.

**Q. Your Cannes appearance was widely appreciated for its elegance. What was the thought behind the look?**
The idea was to keep it elegant and authentic. We didn't want to do something loud just for the sake of being noticed. The focus was on celebrating Indian fabric and character through *khadi*, and Madhav Agasti's vision of presenting the fabric in a contemporary, global context really resonated with me. The look carried a sense of tradition while still feeling modern, and I think that balance is what made it special.

**Q. Without revealing too much, what side of you will audiences discover in your upcoming projects?**
Besides the sides that I tend to hide, the sides that I am sometimes scared of, I think we've got to wait and see.

**Q. Was *Heeramandi* your breakthrough moment—or do you think your real career is only beginning now?**
I think there's nothing taking away from the fact that *Heeramandi* was my breakthrough moment. It was all thanks to Mr Bhansali and Netflix for putting me on global screens. It was all a blessing. But my real career started a long time ago. A real career isn't only about when you're successful; it starts when you're not successful as well.

***—with Akshita Jolly***



*Photograph by* BANDEEP SINGH